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Flash Drives

Brand	Corsair	Kingston	Kingston	Apacer	SanDisk	SanDisk	Transcend	Kingston	OCZ
Model	Flash Voyager 8GB	Data Traveler HyperX 8 GB	Data Traveler Vault Privacy 8GB	AH522 8GB	Ultra Cruzer Titanium 8GB	Ultra Backup 16GB	JetFlash JF V30 16GB	Data Traveler 150 32GB	USB ATV 32GB
Formatted Capacity	7.53	7.46	7.46	7.46	7.48	14.93	14.96	30.05	29.7
Software features	NA	NA	Security, Encryption (DataTraveler Vault Privacy)	NA	U3	U3 + Backup button	JetFlash Elite (Email, Favourites, AutoLogin, SecretZio, Data Backup, PC Lock)	NA	NA
Visual indicators like LED etc.	LED (blue)	LED (blue)	LED (blue)	LED (blue)	LED blue	LED (Orange)	LED (blue)	LED (blue)	LED (Orange)
Other accessories provided	USB Extension, Strap	Lanyard	Lanyard	NA	Tiny key ring	NA	NA	Lanyard	OCZ Key chain
Sturdiness (So10)	8.75	8	7	6	8.25	5.25	4.25	6.75	9.25
Build Quality									
HD-Tach 3.04 (Synthetic test)									
Random Access Time (ms)	0.4	0.8	0.8	0.7	0.5	0.7	4	1.9	1.9
Average read speed (MBps)	32.8	34.5	30.5	31	31.9	25	19.2	32.8	30.7
Read Burst Speed	35	35.1	32.8	31.9	32.9	26.3	23.8	35	31.8
CPU Utilization (per cent)	12	14	10	10	10	8	6	17	5
File Transfer Tests - 4 GB (NTFS)									
Sequential Write (s)	836	183.7	325.7	383	260	331	424.4	231.2	597
Sequential Write Speed (MBps)	4.90	22.30	12.58	10.69	15.75	12.37	9.65	17.72	6.86
Sequential Read (s)	134	126	135	140	134.8	167	290.5	131	144.1
Sequential Read Speed (MBps)	30.57	32.51	30.34	29.26	30.39	24.53	14.10	31.27	28.42
Assorted Write (s)	1044	296.5	541	590.7	502.4	1127.3	581.4	442	1377
Assorted Write Speed (MBps)	3.92	13.81	7.57	6.93	8.15	3.63	7.05	9.27	2.97
Assorted Read (s)	363.5	196.8	201	165.7	168	245	322.6	176	800.7
Assorted Read Speed (MBps)	11.27	20.81	20.38	24.72	24.38	16.72	12.70	23.27	5.12
Price (Rs.)	1,100	3,633	15,591	1,299	1,449	2,499	2,500	5,499	3,900
Performance									

This drive gives you the most formatted capacity, and even though it's a mere 50 to 70 MB more space compared to the others, that's still commendable. Unfortunately, that's where all the praise for this drive stops. Yes, it is the cheapest drive in the test at a mere Rs. 1,100, but do you really want to be sitting around for over 17 minutes waiting for 4 GB of assorted data to copy?

I should tell you that I did a lot more drop testing with this drive after being bored to death waiting for the tests to finish. Those of you who really don't care about transfer speeds, and are more interested in a drive that you can be careless with, this might make a decent buy. It's not an expensive investment, thankfully, and market prices should be even cheaper!

Kingston Data Traveler HyperX

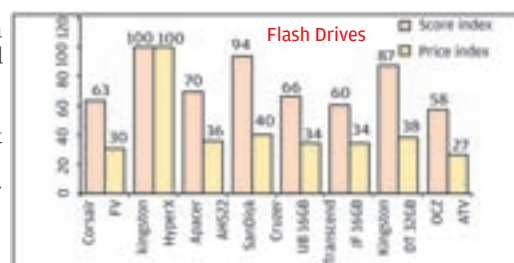
Kingston's HyperX nomenclature is usually associated with system memory, and we've used our fair share while testing other products. Anyone who's followed Kingston products knows that anything HyperX is usually its fastest product in that segment. As soon as I saw the box, I knew this had to be one of the drives I tested last. The reason for that is because if I tested the fastest drives first, I'd fall asleep waiting for the more run-of-the-mill ones to complete tests. So, was this drive the fastest in the test?

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For all flash drives, I ran all tests thrice, to omit any OS overheads that might affect the scores. For the HyperX, I ran the tests five times, just to be sure, and didn't mind at all, because it just breezed through everything I threw at it – most noticeably taking a mere 296.5 seconds (under 5 minutes) to complete the assorted write test. In fact, I even found myself looking at the test files again to check whether they were actually 4 GB in size.

The drive is made up of a metal/rubber mix, which feels pretty sturdy. The drive connector is the sliding type, and the slider mechanism



seems top notch. The blue HyperX look is cool for uber geeks who want to show off to their buddies. With the fastest scores in all but the assorted read test, you can be sure of showing off its performance even more than the branding.

So is there anything bad at all about this drive? As usual, price plays spoilsport. At Rs. 3,633, this is the most expensive normal use drive (read the next review to understand this) in the 8 GB category. You do get what you